

Xerox PE16 All-In-One

A better scan, please

The Xerox PE16 is a laser MFD that can print, copy, scan and fax. The printer can print at a maximum speed of 16 ppm in normal mode. It can go up to 600 dpi if the document includes images or graphics. The paper tray can hold 250 pages, and has separate slots to manually feed in single paper sheets, or media such as envelopes, greeting cards, transparencies and so on. However, the support tray is missing here, and the user needs to push the media into the slot.

The flatbed scanner comes bundled with an Automatic Document Feeder (ADF) that can hold a maximum of 30 sheets at a time. The scanner is capable of scanning at a maximum resolution of 1,200 dpi at 24-bit colour depth.

The PE16 is a stand-alone copier too, which means you can get as many as 99 copies of a document directly from the unit. The menu allows you to set the type of page and the number of copies. A hot key on the keypad allows you to set the contrast and quality level. The toner-save button is a good feature—enabling it makes the printer use less toner. These prints were light, but were good enough for use in office environments.

The PE16 is also a full-fledged fax machine and has all the features of a standalone fax machine. You can use the ADF to send multiple faxes to a single number in one go. The broadcast feature lets you send a single document to multiple numbers. You can set a group dial to send one document to several numbers frequently. The toll-save feature enables you to automatically restrict the

sending of faxes only during the period for which the carrier charges a discounted rate.

We were able to print readable two-point fonts. However, the standard test document took 16.37 seconds—two seconds more than the Xerox Workcentre Pro 412 that we tested earlier.

The scanner was a real letdown, as it was slower than that of any other MFD we've tested. At full-colour mode, we were greeted with dark images, which when tested with Photoshop's Histogram feature, returned pathetic readings. We do not recommend the PE16 for scanning images that will be put to use in presentations and other collaterals.

The PE16 doesn't have network capabilities, and has a comparatively slow printing speed of 17 ppm. However, its faxing and copying features are good enough for us to recommend it for use in small offices as well as departments within large organisations.



+ Good fax features, compact design
- Below-par scan speed and copy quality
Price: Rs 40,000 + local taxes

Xerox PE16 All-In-One B+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶

Conclusion

The popularity of laser printers can only increase. Prices will drop further. As of now, because of toner costs, only SoHo users can afford a laser printer; but once the price gets into the Rs 6,000-7,000 regions, home users will begin considering laser printers. 600 dpi laser printers are entry-level now, and most of them have faster processors; this has enabled them to support both HP's PCL and Adobe's advanced PostScript printing language. PostScript makes it easy for networked users, some of whom might be using Macintosh systems, to print without problems.

Such high-end features at entry-level price will make mono lasers will eat more and more into the dot matrix market, because entry-level models cost just about as much as 130-column dot matrix printers, while offering much faster

speeds and far better quality. Dot matrix usage then will be limited to specialised tasks such as billing, ticketing, etc., where print quality is not important. However, the dot matrix printer will survive, partly because of the low cpp, and partly because of general unwillingness to learn new things.

Large corporates prefer laser MFDs because of their higher duty cycles and low print costs. But everywhere else, it will still be some time before Laser MFDs replace inkjet-based MFDs. Colour lasers are now already under the Rs 50,000 mark, and their prices, too, will come down as the technology matures. Of course, we're still a few years away from the time when colour lasers get to the home.

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